

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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WHO CURRENTLY CROSSES THE THRESHOLD (the doorways) OF OUR LIVES

WHO SPEAKS INTO OUR LIVES?

Preamble:

I was thinking of the practical things about our walk with God and our commitment to serve him and *reflecting on who are the people that speak into our lives because that is important.* I am sure that we have seen some people that make poor decisions simply because they do not approach others who could give them some advice.

Also, there are those are loners and keep to themselves and it seems that they don't have anyone close to them to be able to speak into their lives with encouragement and support.

So, it is vitally important for us to have certain people speak into our lives so that we are able to fruitfully process those necessary things that pertain to our walk with God.

But this is dependent on us being open and willing to have such persons speak into our lives

1. OUR LIVES

* WHO SPEAKS INTO OUR LIVES?

■ WHO CURRENTLY CROSSES THE THRESHOLD – the doorway OF OUR LIVES and encourages, supports and gives us counsel in the things of the Lord?

* WHO ARE THE PEOPLE THAT ARE INVOLVED IN OUR LIFE?

* DO WE HAVE PERSONS THAT CAN GUIDE, COUNSEL AND MENTOR US?

* AND HAVE WE SET ANY BOUNDARIES / RULES FOR THOSE PASSING OVER THE THRESHOLD OF OUR LIVES?

* DO WE HAVE MORE THAN ONE PERSON SPEAKING INTO OUR LIVES

* The Bible is clear about each of us having someone, preferably more than one person that we seek advice and counsel from.

Listen to advice

Proverbs 19:20 Listen to advice and accept instruction, and in the end you will be wise. NIV

Get advice from others

Proverbs 20:18 Get advice if you want your plans to work. If you go to war, get the advice of others. NCV

Many advisers

Proverbs 11:14 For lack of guidance a nation falls, but many advisers make victory sure. NIV

Proverbs 15:22 Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed. NIV

There is Safety

Proverbs 11:14 Where no counsel is, the people fall: but in the multitude of counsellors there is safety. KJV

Advice from friends

Proverbs 27:9-10

9 The heartfelt counsel of a friend is as sweet as perfume and incense.

10 Never abandon a friend— either yours or your father's. NLT

Question:

■ WHAT KIND OF PERSONS ARE THEY?

■ ARE THOSE WHO ARE SPEAKING INTO YOUR LIFE PERSONS OF INTEGRITY, COMPASSION AND IMPARTIALITY?

■ ARE THEY KNOWN FOR THEIR FAITHFULNESS IN TEACHING GODLY PRINCIPLES?

■ WE NEED TO CHOOSE SUCH PERSONS WHO WILL SPEAK TRUTHFULLY TO US AND NOT JUST agree with us maybe like our friends etc.

- * HEARING THE TRUTH IS IMPORTANT but sometimes disagreeable and a little painful but the Scriptures states:

Proverbs 27:6 Faithful are the wounds of a friend (who corrects out of Love and concern) but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful because they serve his hidden agenda AMP

Proverbs 23:23 Buy the truth and do not sell it; get wisdom, discipline and understanding. NIV

Proverbs 23:23 Acquire truth and do not sell it - wisdom, and discipline, and understanding. NET

Integrity guides good people

Proverbs 11:3 Honesty guides good people; dishonesty destroys treacherous people. NLT

Proverbs 11:3 The integrity of the upright guides them, but the unfaithful are destroyed by their duplicity. NIV

Psalms 25:21 May integrity and honesty protect me, for I put my hope in you. NLT

Proverbs 20:7 The godly walk with integrity; blessed are their children who follow them. NLT

Proverbs 20:7 The just man walketh in his integrity: his children are blessed after him. KJV

2. PROTECTING OUR HEARTS

THIS MEANS TO BE CAREFUL WHAT WE ALLOW TO ENTER OUR HEART – I.E. THAT CROSSES THE THRESHOLD OF YOUR HEART

Proverbs 4:23-24 - 23 Guard your heart above all else, for it determines the course of your life.

- 24 Avoid all perverse talk; stay away from corrupt speech. NLT

- Perverse means - STUBBORN – HEADSTRONG

- Corrupt means - DISHONEST, CROOKED, IMMORAL.

- DON'T ALLOW OUR HEART TO BE EXPOSED TO THAT KIND OF TALK; AVOID, STAY AWAY.

- SET SOME RULES AS TO WHAT YOUR HEART WILL BE EXPOSED TO.

- THIS IS OUR RESPONSIBILITY – NOT GOD'S

3. THE LISTENING EAR?

- It is good to be a listener and open to taking time to hear the story of those who are just wanting someone to hear their story of sorrow, hurt or abuse etc.

- Many people are just wanting a listening ear.

Proverbs 21:13 Whoever ignores the poor when they cry for help will also cry for help and not be answered. NCV

Proverbs 21:13 If a man shuts his ears to the cry of the poor, he too will cry out and not be answered. NIV

Proverbs 21:13 If you stop your ears to the cries of the poor, your cries will go unheard, unanswered. The MESSAGE:

- However, WE SHOULD ALSO set a watchman at the door of our ears to test / TRY the nature and spirit of the words we are exposed to.

- ALLOWING our ears to entertain words and stories that are not in agreement with what God says can affect our emotions and thoughts in a negative sense.

- We should not allow our ears to deliberately listen to negative fear-filled talk or criticism and cynical spirited people.

- We must set a guard at the door of our ears because the Bible states that:

- * THE EAR tests words like our mouths taste food before committing it to our lives/ bodies

Job 34:3 For the ear tests words as the tongue tastes food. NIV

Job 34:3 Job said, 'The ear tests the words it hears just as the mouth distinguishes between foods.' NLT

Job 34:3 Doesn't the ear test words as the palate tastes food? Holman

Are we discreet and discerning in what we listen to – refusing some 'talk' to enter and remain in us.

Who do we allow to cross over the threshold of our lives

Proverbs 22:17-18 17 Listen to the words of the wise; apply your heart to my instruction. –

18 For it is good to keep these sayings in your heart and always ready on your lips. NLT

Proverbs 20:15 Wise words are more valuable than much gold and many rubies. NLT

- WHO DO WE LISTEN TO, WHAT KIND OF PERSONS DO WE ALLOW OUR EARS TO CONTINUE TO LISTEN TO WRONG THINGS?

Proverbs 17:4 Wrongdoers eagerly listen to gossip; liars pay close attention to slander. NLT

Proverbs 17:5 Those who mock the poor insult their Maker; those who rejoice at the misfortune of others will be punished. NLT

- HAVE WE SET CONSTRAINTS ON WHAT OUR EARS HEAR?

- HAVE WE SET A WATCHMAN AT THE DOOR/THRESHOLD OF OUR EARS?

Amen – Ps Barry